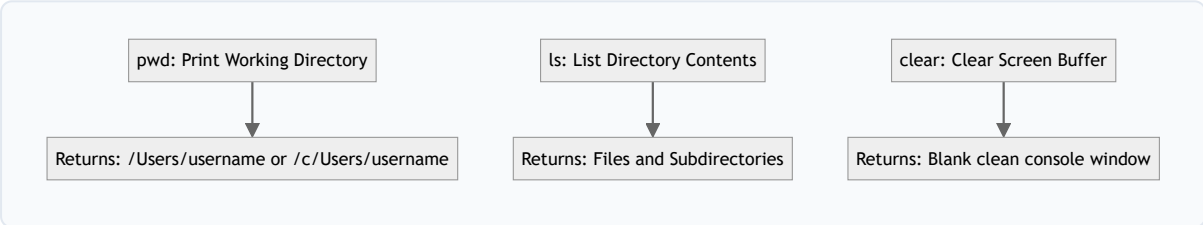
Submodule 34.05: Fundamental Inspection Commands: `ls`, `pwd`, `clear`, and History

Topic Overview & Inspection Mechanics

Before navigating or modifying file structures, developers must inspect their current operational environment. Three fundamental commands provide this spatial awareness:

1. `pwd`: Where am I? (Print Working Directory)
2. `ls`: What is here? (List Files and Folders)
3. `clear`: Reset terminal visual screen buffer.



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1. Detailed Command Syntax & Behavior

A. `pwd` (Print Working Directory)

Outputs the absolute path of the directory in which the shell session is currently operating.

```
pwd
# Output on macOS:   /Users/Shraddha
# Output in Git Bash: /c/Users/Shivam
```

Significance: In CLI, there are no visual breadcrumb bars like in File Explorer. `pwd` gives you your exact absolute address in the file hierarchy.

B. `ls` (List)

Lists all visible files, documents, and subdirectories contained inside the current working directory.

```
ls
# Output:
```

```
# Desktop  Documents  Downloads  Music  Pictures  Videos  Delta
```

- By default, `ls` displays only visible files. Hidden configuration files (starting with `.`) are omitted.
- Directory and folder names are conventionally used interchangeably in terminal discussions.

C. `clear` (Clear Terminal Screen)

Clears all previous commands and terminal text output, repositioning the prompt at the top-left corner of the window.

```
clear
```

Keyboard Shortcut: Alternatively, pressing `Ctrl + L` on Windows/Linux or `Cmd + K` on macOS accomplishes the same visual reset without clearing history.

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2. Command History Navigation via Arrow Keys

Terminal emulators maintain an internal buffer of executed commands:

- **Up Arrow (↑)**: Recalls previously executed commands in reverse chronological order (older commands).
- **Down Arrow (↓)**: Moves forward toward the most recently typed commands.
- *Developer Efficiency*: Never retype long, complex command paths. Tap the Up Arrow to retrieve and re-execute prior instructions.